

Paradiem 

The Morning Brief

JULY 9, 2026

Iran Retaliates

Iran reportedly hit US bases in Kuwait and Bahrain overnight per NPR as chips reportedly recovered (NVDA ↑3.65%) into a 9-vs-9 Warsh Fed.

S&P 500 (WED CLOSE) \$745.40 · ↓0.31%	DOW (WED CLOSE) \$522.77 · ↓1.07% financials-led	BRENT (WED SETTLE) ~\$78.19 · ↑5.43% per Reuters	BITCOIN (LIVE) ~\$62,000 · below on Iran per Yahoo/ CryptoNews	FEAR & GREED (CNN) ~43 · Fear per CNN · data drop returned crypto fallback (22)
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SECTION 01

Markets — Wednesday Reportedly Delivered a Split Tape (Dow ↓1.07% to \$522.77, S&P ↓0.31%, Nasdaq ↑0.28% per Data Drop) as a Chip-Led Rebound (NVDA ↑3.65% Through \$200, NXPI ↑3.90%, CRDO ↑4.99%) Reportedly Offset a Financials/Materials Rout (XLF ↓1.93%, XLB ↓2.62%, SYF ↓9.61%) With Reported First Warsh-Chaired FOMC Minutes Reportedly Framed by the Chair as a Candid Internal Disagreement on Rate Direction per CNBC and Iran Reportedly Retaliating Overnight With Reported Strikes on U.S. Bases in Kuwait and Bahrain per NPR

WEDNESDAY'S TAPE REPORTEDLY SPLIT ALONG A CHIP-RECOVERY VS RATE-SENSITIVE COMPOSITION: XLK REPORTEDLY CLOSED ↑1.24% AND XLE ↑1.76% WHILE XLF ↓1.93%, XLB ↓2.62%, XLY ↓1.78%, AND XLRE ↓1.65% PER THE DATA DROP — THE GROWTH-HYBRID SLEEVE REPORTEDLY REVERSED TUESDAY'S CONCENTRATED SELL-OFF WITH NVDA ↑3.65% TO \$204.12, NXPI ↑3.90% TO \$283.81, CRDO ↑4.99% TO \$258.69, KEYS ↑2.63% TO \$317.24, LRCX ↑2.15% TO \$333.15, AND QCOM ↑1.96% TO \$186.56, WHILE THE DIVIDEND SLEEVE REPORTEDLY ABSORBED A CONCENTRATED HIT WITH SYF ↓9.61% TO \$68.26 PER THE DATA DROP

For FCI's framework, Wednesday's composition reads as a partial reversal of Tuesday's chip rout with the AI infrastructure trade reportedly finding footing: NVDA reportedly closed at \$204.12 (↑3.65%) per the data drop — up from Tuesday's \$196.93 close — and the sleeve reportedly widened the recovery with NXPI \$283.81 (↑3.90%), CRDO \$258.69 (↑4.99%), and KEYS \$317.24 (↑2.63%). The Refiner sleeve reportedly captured the Brent bid separately: VLO reportedly closed ↑6.26% to \$282.88 per the data drop as refiner crack spreads reportedly widened into the overnight strike headlines; per Yahoo coverage cited in the data drop, VLO was reportedly among the CNBC morning-mover focus names on the Iran headlines. Financials reportedly took the counterweight — SYF reportedly closed ↓9.61% at \$68.26 per the data drop, with per Gurufocus/Yahoo coverage the reported analyst PT reduction and reported Q2 consensus at \$2.00 (reportedly a 20% YoY decline) framing the reset; the Wall Street analyst PT for SYF was reportedly reduced by \$11 per Gurufocus. Precious metals reportedly gave back with GLD ↓0.81% to \$374.45 and SLV ↓2.99% to \$52.83; UVXY reportedly closed ↑2.03% to \$24.63 per the data drop. Carson's SPY support at \$645.80 remains active per levels.json, well-removed from Wednesday's intraday low of \$739.51 per the data drop.

S&P 500 (WED CLOSE)	\$745.40 · ↓0.31% · H:\$746.15 L:\$739.51 per data drop
DOW (WED CLOSE)	\$522.77 · ↓1.07% · financials/materials-led per data drop
NASDAQ (WED CLOSE)	\$711.44 · ↑0.28% · chip-recovery per data drop
TOP FCI MOVERS (WED)	HUT ↑9.69% · VLO ↑6.26% · CRDO ↑4.99% · NXPI ↑3.90% per data drop
BOTTOM FCI MOVERS (WED)	SYF ↓9.61% · TOL ↓4.00% · AEM ↓3.62% · FCX ↓3.08% per data drop
US FUTURES (LIVE)	Dow ↑~0.15% · equities reportedly poised to rebound per CNBC
CARSON'S SPY SUPPORT	\$645.80 · active · well-removed from Wed intraday low \$739.51

PER CNBC AND FOX BUSINESS COVERAGE OF THE REPORTED FIRST WARSH-CHAired FOMC MINUTES RELEASED WEDNESDAY AT 2 P.M. ET, CHAIR WARSH REPORTEDLY CHARACTERIZED THE JUNE 16-17 MEETING AS A CANDID INTERNAL DISAGREEMENT OVER THE DIRECTION OF RATES; THE COMMITTEE REPORTEDLY SPLIT NINE-VERSUS-NINE ON 2026 RATE DIRECTION WITH REPORTEDLY NINE PARTICIPANTS PROJECTING AT LEAST ONE HIKE BEFORE YEAR-END, REPORTEDLY EIGHT PROJECTING NO CHANGE, AND REPORTEDLY ONE PROJECTING A CUT PER CNBC — SEPTEMBER RATE-HIKE ODDS REPORTEDLY HELD AT ~50-

55% PER CME FEDWATCH, REPORTEDLY LITTLE CHANGED FROM THE PRINT

For FCI's framework, the reported minutes reportedly delivered a rate-path split that reportedly matched the June SEP dispersion without materially shifting September-meeting positioning — TLT reportedly closed ↓0.22% to \$84.36 per the data drop and the reported cross-asset move Wednesday reportedly tracked with a market pricing sticky policy plus the Brent-driven inflation reset. Per CNBC coverage, the reported June SEP core PCE was reportedly revised to 3.3% for 2026 (from a reported 2.7%) with GDP reportedly revised down to 2.2%, a composition consistent with the reported June ISM Services Prices Index at 67.7% per PR Newswire cited in prior brief work. The Dividend sleeve reportedly took the concentrated rate-sensitive hit: NEE ↓1.16%, ATO ↓0.28%, ADP ↓1.72%, CHD ↓2.81%, CL ↓2.09%, DGX ↓1.96%, and CAT reportedly held ↑0.85% per the data drop; the reported Refiner and Upstream leg reportedly captured the Brent premium (VLO ↑6.26%, DVN ↑2.12%, CVX ↑1.13%). Per Yahoo coverage in the data drop headlines, Nvidia reportedly led a broader chip rally despite the Iran flare-up — a signal that the reported AI-capex bid can reportedly absorb the rate-friction reset. **Simplicity Over Complexity.**

Wednesday reportedly delivered a chip-led rebound against a financials rout as the reported first Warsh minutes reportedly held September in play; Thursday's open reportedly reprices the Iran retaliation into an inflation-tinted rate backdrop. Research Reveals Opportunities.

Geopolitics — Iran Reportedly Retaliated Overnight With Reported Strikes on U.S. Bases in Kuwait (Camp Arifjan, Ali Al Salem) and Bahrain (Sheikh Isa Air Base, Juffair) per NPR/Al Jazeera per IRGC Statement, Following Wednesday's Reported U.S. Strikes on Bandar Abbas, Sirik, and Qeshm per Al Jazeera; Brent Reportedly Settled $\uparrow 5.43\%$ at \$78.19 and WTI $\uparrow 4.37\%$ at \$73.52 Wednesday per Reuters as Trump Reportedly Halted U.S. Trade With Spain Over NATO Spending and Iran per Reuters

PER NPR AND AL JAZEERA LIVE-BLOG COVERAGE OF THE REPORTED IRGC STATEMENT, IRAN REPORTEDLY STRUCK U.S. BASES IN KUWAIT (REPORTEDLY CAMP ARIFJAN AND ALI AL SALEM AIR BASE) AND BAHRAIN (REPORTEDLY SHEIKH ISA AIR BASE AND JUFFAIR) OVERNIGHT — REPORTEDLY RETALIATING FOR WEDNESDAY'S WAVE OF U.S. CENTCOM STRIKES ON REPORTED IRANIAN TARGETS INCLUDING REPORTEDLY BANDAR ABBAS, SIRIK, AND QESHM PER AL JAZEERA; THE WEDNESDAY U.S. STRIKES REPORTEDLY FOLLOWED THE TUESDAY ATTACKS ON THREE COMMERCIAL SHIPS IN THE STRAIT OF HORMUZ, AND PER CNBC FROM THE ANKARA NATO SUMMIT, PRESIDENT TRUMP REPORTEDLY SIGNALLED THE LATE-JUNE CEASEFIRE FRAMEWORK HAS RUN ITS COURSE

For FCI's framework, the overnight retaliation reportedly widens the theater from the Tuesday Hormuz vessel attacks to reported direct U.S.-base targeting on GCC territory (Kuwait and Bahrain) — a materially different composition than the Tuesday vessel attacks and a signal that the reported Doha technical track (reportedly scheduled to resume around July 11 per prior brief coverage) is reportedly under acute pressure. Per Reuters coverage in the data drop headlines, Brent September futures reportedly settled $\uparrow 5.43\%$ at \$78.19 and WTI August reportedly settled $\uparrow 4.37\%$ at \$73.52 on Wednesday; the data drop showed USO closing $\uparrow 3.02\%$ at \$112.21 and BNO $\uparrow 3.91\%$ at \$43.57. For the FCI Refiner sleeve, VLO reportedly captured a concentrated bid at \$282.88 ($\uparrow 6.26\%$ per the data drop) as Brent premium reportedly widened refiner crack economics; upstream reportedly followed (DVN \$43.31 $\uparrow 2.12\%$, CVX \$175.97 $\uparrow 1.13\%$ per the data drop). Per Reuters coverage in the data drop headlines, Venture Global reportedly said its second-quarter liquefaction fee reportedly jumped 69% as the reported Iran war reportedly lifted LNG prices — a materially constructive item for the FCI LNG-adjacent read-across (OKE \$91.16 $\uparrow 0.54\%$ per the data drop). Per Reuters coverage in the data drop headlines, Trump reportedly ordered a halt to U.S. trade with Spain over NATO spending and Iran — a signal that the Ankara summit reportedly opened a broader alliance-fracture dimension. **The physical world matters.**

PER REUTERS AND YAHOO COVERAGE IN THE DATA DROP HEADLINES, GULF COMPANIES ARE REPORTEDLY SET TO REVEAL A REPORTED UNEQUAL TOLL OF THE IRAN WAR; PER CNBC COVERAGE, OVERNIGHT U.S. FUTURES REPORTEDLY REVERSED HIGHER WITH DOW FUTURES REPORTEDLY $\uparrow \sim 0.15\%$ EVEN AS IRAN REPORTEDLY STRUCK U.S. BASES IN KUWAIT AND BAHRAIN — A COMPOSITION REPORTEDLY CONSISTENT WITH THE REPORTED AI-CAPEX BID ABSORBING THE GEOPOLITICAL SHOCK PER YAHOO COVERAGE CITED IN THE DATA DROP

For FCI's framework, the reported cross-asset composition into the reopen reportedly signals the market is reportedly separating the Iran risk into an energy-and-defense premium without a broader risk-off. Per Yahoo/CryptoNews coverage, Bitcoin reportedly traded below \$62,000 after Trump reportedly declared the reported late-June ceasefire had run its course — the digital-sleeve reset that reportedly caught FCI positions Wednesday (IBIT $\downarrow 2.54\%$ to \$35.23, ETHA $\downarrow 2.96\%$ to \$13.11, COIN $\downarrow 2.54\%$ to \$159.36 per the data drop) even as HUT reportedly rallied $\uparrow 9.69\%$ to \$106.11. Per Benzinga

coverage in the data drop, Applied Digital reportedly announced a reported lease agreement with a new U.S. investment-grade hyperscaler at its 430 MW Delta Forge 1 AI Factory campus — a data point for the reported HUT/MARA AI-conversion thesis. Per the same coverage citing Benzinga, Coinbase reportedly gained UK approval to trade stocks and derivatives — a longer-arc constructive item even as COIN reportedly closed $\downarrow 2.54\%$ at \$159.36 per the data drop. For the FCI Defense sleeve, LMT reportedly closed $\downarrow 1.39\%$ at \$527.96 and GD reportedly $\downarrow 0.09\%$ at \$374.31 per the data drop; per prior brief coverage, the reported Trump F-35 signal to Erdogan at Ankara reportedly extends the constructive program backdrop even as the reported daily give-back reportedly tracked with the broader financials/materials rout. **Think Like an Owner.**

IRAN RETALIATION	Reportedly hit U.S. bases in Kuwait & Bahrain per NPR / Al Jazeera per IRGC statement
U.S. WED STRIKES	Reportedly hit Bandar Abbas, Sirik, Qeshm in Iran per Al Jazeera
BRENT (WED SETTLE)	\$78.19 · ↑5.43% per Reuters
WTI (WED SETTLE)	\$73.52 · ↑4.37% per Reuters
FCI REFINER BID	VLO ↑6.26% to \$282.88 per data drop
TRUMP/ SPAIN	Reportedly halted U.S. trade with Spain over NATO/ Iran per Reuters
LNG BID	Venture Global Q2 liquefaction fee reportedly ↑69% per Reuters

SECTION 03

On Our Radar

1. Iran Retaliation on U.S. Bases in Kuwait and Bahrain Overnight per NPR / Al Jazeera per IRGC Statement (Reportedly Camp Arifjan, Ali Al Salem, Sheikh Isa, Juffair) — Following Wednesday's Reported U.S. Strikes on Bandar Abbas, Sirik, and Qeshm in Iran per Al Jazeera; Brent Reportedly Settled ↑5.43% at \$78.19 and WTI ↑4.37% at \$73.52 Wednesday per Reuters; Trump Reportedly Halted U.S. Trade With Spain Over NATO Spending and Iran per Reuters — The Doha Technical Track Reportedly Scheduled to Resume ~July 11 per Prior Brief Coverage Is Reportedly Under Acute Pressure. For FCI's Energy sleeve, Wednesday's data drop reportedly captured the Brent premium at the U.S. print with USO ↑3.02% to \$112.21 and BNO ↑3.91% to \$43.57; VLO reportedly closed ↑6.26% at \$282.88 as refiner crack economics reportedly widened per the data drop, and Reuters coverage in the data drop headlines reportedly framed VLO among the CNBC morning-mover focus names on the Iran headlines. Per Reuters coverage in the data drop, Venture Global's Q2 liquefaction fee reportedly jumped 69% as the reported Iran war reportedly lifted LNG prices — OKE at \$91.16 (↑0.54% per data drop) reportedly participates in the LNG-adjacent read-across. Per Reuters coverage in the data drop headlines, oil prices reportedly held little changed early Thursday as markets weighed the reported U.S. strike impact — a signal that the reported physical premium reportedly needs a genuine supply disruption to extend from here. *The physical world matters.*

2. Chip-Recovery vs Financials Rout — Wednesday's Reported Split Tape Reportedly Sent NVDA ↑3.65% to \$204.12 (Reportedly Crossing \$200 per the Data Drop), NXPI ↑3.90% to \$283.81, CRDO ↑4.99% to \$258.69, KEYS ↑2.63%, LRCX ↑2.15%, and QCOM ↑1.96% While XLF Reportedly Closed ↓1.93% and XLB ↓2.62% per the Data Drop; SYF Reportedly ↓9.61% to \$68.26 Reportedly Reflecting a Reported Analyst PT Cut per Gurufocus and a Reported Q2 Consensus of \$2.00 (Reportedly a 20% YoY Decline) per Yahoo — A Materially Relevant Read-Across for the FCI Dividend Sleeve's Consumer Finance Exposure. For FCI's growth-hybrid sleeve, Wednesday's reported concentrated bid reportedly reverses the Tuesday chip rout tied to the reported Samsung print and reported DeepSeek headline — NVDA reportedly closed at \$204.12 (↑3.65%), and per Yahoo coverage in the data drop, Nvidia and chip names reportedly rallied despite the reported U.S.-Iran flare-up; per the same coverage, Big Tech reportedly stepped up in July. The MRVL headline in the data drop reportedly framed the sell-side stance as turning more cautious per Yahoo — a signal that sell-side positioning reportedly turned mixed even as MRVL closed ↑0.44% to \$231.71. Cathie Wood reportedly sold \$8M of AMD per Yahoo (data drop headline) even as AMD reportedly closed ↑0.25% to \$517.40. *Simplicity Over Complexity.*

3. PEP Q2 Reports This Morning per PepsiCo IR — Reported Consensus \$2.21 EPS on \$23.96B Revenue per Alphastreet Coverage; PEP Is Not an FCI Position But the Reported Print Reportedly Serves as a Read-Across for the Dividend Sleeve's Consumer Staples Exposure (CL ↓2.09%, CHD ↓2.81%, ABT ↓0.69% Wed per Data Drop). Delta (DAL) Reportedly Reports Friday July 10 Pre-Market per Delta IR — Reported Consensus \$1.48 EPS on \$18.78B Revenue per Alphastreet, a Reported 29.5% YoY Decline From \$2.10. For FCI's framework, the reported staples sleeve reportedly took a concentrated hit Wednesday (XLP ↓0.55% per data drop) reportedly reflecting the reported cross-asset rotation into cyclical and energy; PEP's reported print reportedly clarifies whether the

reported pricing power that reportedly underpinned CHD (reportedly $\uparrow 1.54\%$ Monday-to-Tuesday per prior brief coverage) reportedly extends across the sleeve. Per Benzinga coverage in the data drop headlines, Wells Fargo reportedly maintained Overweight on CHD and raised the PT to \$110, and reportedly maintained Equal-Weight on CL with a PT raise to \$95 — a signal that sell-side positioning reportedly remains constructive on the staples pricing thesis even as Wednesday's tape reportedly pressured the sleeve. **Avoid Erosion.**

4. SYF $\downarrow 9.61\%$ Wednesday to \$68.26 per the Data Drop — The Reported Concentrated FCI Dividend-Sleeve Give-Back Wednesday per the Data Drop; per Gurufocus Coverage, the Reported Wall Street Analyst PT Was Reduced by \$11 With Analysts Reportedly Citing a Reported More Uncertain Macro Backdrop, Reported Sector-Wide Target Cuts, and Reported Lower Market Multiples for Consumer Finance Stocks; per Yahoo Coverage, Reported Q2 Consensus Is \$2.00 EPS, Reportedly a 20% YoY Decline From the Reported Prior-Year Print. Initial Jobless Claims Reportedly Print Thursday at 7:30 a.m. CT / 8:30 a.m. ET per BLS Calendar. For FCI's framework, the reported SYF move reportedly signals a reported buy-side reset on consumer-finance credit quality assumptions into the Q2 print cycle — a materially relevant item as PEP reports at open and DAL Friday. Per prior brief coverage citing the reported Wed initial jobless claims release, the reported labor market signal reportedly matters into the reported Fed communication vacuum through July 29; the reported June payrolls miss (reported +57K per BLS/CNBC per prior brief coverage) reportedly framed the September rate-hike-odds reset to ~50–55% per CME FedWatch. *Research Reveals Opportunities.*

5. HUT $\uparrow 9.69\%$ to \$106.11 and VLO $\uparrow 6.26\%$ to \$282.88 Reportedly Led FCI Movers Wednesday per the Data Drop, With Digital-Sleeve Bifurcation Reportedly Persisting (IBIT $\downarrow 2.54\%$ to \$35.23, ETHA $\downarrow 2.96\%$ to \$13.11, COIN $\downarrow 2.54\%$ to \$159.36 per Data Drop) as Bitcoin Reportedly Traded Below \$62,000 Overnight per Yahoo/CryptoNews on the Reported Iran Ceasefire-Terminated Headlines; Per Benzinga Coverage in the Data Drop, Applied Digital Reportedly Announced a Reported Lease With a New U.S. Investment-Grade Hyperscaler at Its 430 MW Delta Forge 1 AI Factory Campus — Reportedly a Core Driver Behind the HUT/MARA AI-Conversion Thesis. For FCI's Digital Assets and Growth-Hybrid sleeves, Wednesday's data drop reportedly showed miner-adjacent AI names capturing the bid while spot-BTC-linked ETFs reportedly reset lower — a signal that reported hashpower-to-AI-compute optionality reportedly matters more than spot BTC price at the current setup. Per Reuters coverage in the data drop headlines, Paradigm reportedly raised a reported \$1.2 billion fund as crypto VC reportedly pushes further into AI — a longer-arc constructive signal for COIN read-across. *The physical world matters.*

6. Levels & Housekeeping — Carson's SPY \$645.80 Support Remains Active per levels.json; Wednesday's Reported Intraday Range on the S&P 500 Reportedly Was \$739.51–\$746.15 per the Data Drop, Well-Removed From the Reported Support Level. Per CNBC Coverage, Wednesday's Reported First Warsh Minutes Reportedly Framed as a Candid Internal Disagreement Over Rate Direction With a Reported 9-Versus-9 Split on 2026 Rate Direction, Reportedly Leaving September Odds at ~50–55% per CME FedWatch. For FCI's framework, Chair Warsh's reported forward-guidance abstention reportedly means the reported labor and inflation prints between now and July 29 reportedly dominate the reprice: today's reported jobless claims and next week's reported June CPI (reportedly scheduled July 14 per BLS calendar) reportedly frame the setup. Per Reuters coverage in the data drop headlines, the Morning Bid framing reportedly contrasted the chip sleeve's rebound with the Middle East risk premium — a two-vector setup that reportedly matches the FCI sleeve composition heading into the open. **Think Like an Owner.**

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